

CHRISTOPHER IAIN VICTOR FARMER

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LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/civfarmer](https://www.linkedin.com/in/civfarmer) Web CV: <https://civfarmer.github.io/CV/>

Right to work: Swiss B Permit | **Languages:** English (Native), French
(A2-Actively undertaking intensive training to achieve B2 professional proficiency),
Spanish (Basic)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Dynamic Legal and Compliance leader holding an LL.M. in Legal Practice (International Law), acting as the legal nexus for complex operations. With over 8 years of experience, I build scalable governance frameworks, regulatory compliance documentation, and robust procurement protocols. I am highly adept at contract lifecycle management, risk mitigation, HR advisory, and the strategic implementation of AI and automation to reduce operational overhead.

Uniquely positioned at the intersection of law and technology, I seamlessly bridge the gap between engineering and legal teams. While fundamentally a legal and operations head, I possess the technical fluency to independently review code, audit agentic AI workflows, and verify that software architecture meets strict legal and procedural requirements without requiring developer translation.

I further leverage this technical edge alongside a deep understanding of the ever-evolving cyber-economic landscape. Drawing on advanced academic research in economic and cyber warfare, I am highly capable of anticipating state-actor methodologies and mapping complex geopolitical threats directly to institutional risk management and regulatory resilience.

CORE COMPETENCIES & EXPERTISE

Legal Advisory & Corporate Governance

- **Qualifying Work Experience (QWE):** 5+ years of demonstrable legal practice experience (Solicitors Regulation Authority - QWE) encompassing contract drafting, administrative decision-making, dispute resolution, and policy architecture.
- **Corporate Governance:** Extensive experience advising executive boards and acting as a Trustee. Proficient in establishing scalable governance frameworks, shareholder agreements, delegation of authority matrices, and conflict-of-interest controls.

- Contract Lifecycle Management (CLM): End-to-end ownership of supplier agreements, Memorandums of Understanding, service delivery contracts, and institutional grant terms. Skilled in negotiating liability, indemnity, and data handling clauses.
- Dispute Resolution: Early assessment, evidence preservation, and settlement strategy formulation. Successfully mitigated over £70,000 in potential damages during board-level tenure.

Cyber Resilience & Operational Risk (Thought Leadership)

- Doctorate-Level Expertise: Invited to pursue doctoral research based on an LL.M. dissertation (awarded 100%) exploring enforcement gaps in international obligations and Economic/Cyber Warfare.
- Operational Security Insight: Expert in predicting state-actor methodologies and exploiting international legal vulnerabilities via third-party economic and cyber intermediaries. Highly capable of mapping these geopolitical cyber-threats to institutional risk management and regulatory resilience (e.g., FINMA, EU DORA).

Regulatory Compliance & Risk Management

- Framework Design: Built and embedded "compliance by default" programs across 8 operational sites. Converted complex statutory and funder requirements (EEC, UK Government, National Lottery) into actionable checklists, approval gates, and evidence logs matched with both human safeguards and training.
- Operational Integrity & Audit Readiness: Maintained 100% audit pass rates. Designed robust risk registers and incident reporting pipelines to track and remediate compliance failures, safeguarding concerns, and data breaches (GDPR).
- Swiss & Financial Sector Readiness: Deep understanding of AML/CFT concepts, cross-border restrictions, and institutional risk management. Positioned to operationalise FINMA-aligned compliance controls using risk-based methodologies and rigorous evidence trails.

Financial, Procurement, & Commercial Operations

- Public Sector Grant Management & NGO Institutional Funding: Partnered with leadership to secure and manage over £500,000 in public and lottery funding. Navigated strict funder compliance, milestone reporting, and payment conditions.

- **Procurement Controls:** Designed vendor risk management and procurement protocols for publicly funded environments, ensuring value-for-money documentation, separation of duties, and strict supplier due diligence.
- **Financial Oversight:** Board-level experience in budget scrutiny, cashflow prioritisation, deficit mitigation, and establishing "financial war-rooms" during periods of organisational strain.

Digital Transformation & AI Integration

- **System Implementation:** Spearheaded the full migration of paper-based operational and educational services to cloud-based systems (Moodle), ensuring operational continuity during COVID-19 and reducing operating costs by 30%.
- **Agentic AI & Automation:** Advanced capability in designing structured LLM workflows for policy gap analysis, control mapping, and automated drafting. Built Python/API tools to retrieve data and automate compliance dashboards, maintaining strict human-in-the-loop governance.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

RED SPARK LEARNING C.I.C. | Herefordshire, UK An educational community interest company that grew to become the largest adult learning provider in the three counties (surpassed only by local colleges and universities), operating across 8+ locations with 15 staff.

Director / Head of Legal & Compliance | Jan 2018 - Aug 2024

Assistant to Director / Business Development Support | Jan 2015 - Jan 2018

- *Mandate: Act as the legal and operational backbone of the organisation. Protect funding eligibility, establish corporate governance, manage commercial contracts, and ensure compliance with stringent UK education, GDPR, and safeguarding regulations.*
- **Legal Advisory & Corporate Governance (SRA QWE):** Advised the executive board on statutory obligations, conflicts of interest, and Community Interest Company (CIC) regulatory filings (Companies Act 2006). Created and governed the organisation's comprehensive legal policy suite.
- **Commercial Contracting & Public Sector Grants (SRA QWE):** Drafted, reviewed, and negotiated a high volume of commercial contracts, supplier agreements, and NGO Institutional Funding frameworks. Strictly controlled liability, indemnity, and termination clauses to protect organisational interests.
- **Dispute Resolution & Pre-Litigation (SRA QWE):** Managed early-stage dispute resolution for vendor conflicts and complex stakeholder grievances. Drafted settlement agreements

and preserved evidence, successfully avoiding costly tribunal or court proceedings through strategic negotiation.

- **Data Protection & Information Law:** Spearheaded GDPR compliance frameworks across 8 sites. Executed Data Protection Impact Assessments (DPIAs) for cloud infrastructure rollouts and managed Subject Access Requests (SARS) within statutory deadlines.
- **Compliance & Audit Operations:** Maintained impeccable audit readiness for highly scrutinized EEC, Lottery, and central government funds. Designed and implemented live dashboards and risk registers to track compliance obligations, resulting in uninterrupted operations during shifting national regulations.
- **Commercial Growth & Bid Writing:** Spearheaded the research and drafting of high-value funding bids. Successfully procured a £200,000 EEC and Lottery Bid Partnership, driving infrastructure expansion and team growth.
- **HR Advisory & Crisis Management:** Directed internal administrative matters including capability reviews, conflict resolution, and complex grievance procedures. Ensured procedural fairness, defensible recordkeeping, and strict adherence to employment law during organisational restructuring.
- **Digital Transformation:** Pioneered a critical infrastructure pivot during the COVID-19 lockdowns, successfully migrating all educational and administrative services online. Automated manual workflows, directly reducing operating costs by 30% and ensuring total business continuity.

HVOSS (Herefordshire Voluntary Organisations Support Service) | Herefordshire, UK Board Member / Trustee | Oct 2022 - Jul 2024 Provided non-executive governance, legal insight, and strategic financial oversight for a registered charity supporting regional voluntary organisations during a period of acute financial challenge.

- **Crisis finance governance (deficit control):** Joined during a projected ~£100k+ year-end deficit with multi-project shortfalls (Community Wheels ~£20k - 30k, BBO ~£11k, Talk Community ~£6k); supported emergency board action to convene a Funding/Finance review group and prioritise corrective decisions and cashflow controls.
- **Turnaround tracking (forecast → recovery):** Oversaw scrutiny of management accounts where Oct-2022 half-year accounts forecast a £108k deficit, improving by May-2023 to -£13k (year-end journals expected to adjust to ~-£58k due to Community Wheels spend considered 'community essential'), while confirming ~£290k cash on a reconciled balance sheet and strengthening reporting discipline.

- Cashflow protection + contract/overhead governance: Supported liquidity optimisation including exploring £100k–£150k placement into a 30-day notice account; enforced audit-trail discipline by refusing £3.6k ineligible partner costs embedded in a £30k+ invoice; supported stabilisation of fixed overheads via Broad Street lease extension (+5 years from 2023 to end-2028).

INDEPENDENT INVESTMENT PORTFOLIO | Geneva, CH / UK Private Investor & Portfolio Manager | Jan 2021 - Present Self-directed management of a private trading portfolio, applying institutional-grade macroeconomic research, algorithmic trading, and risk controls.

- Financial Analysis & Market Research: Conducted meticulous fundamental and technical analysis of US, UK, and EU equities. Tracked the market impacts of geopolitical events, international policy shifts, and macroeconomic data.
- Performance: Achieved ~150% financial growth on equity investments over a 12-month period, with an approximately 75% return in 2024.
- Algorithmic Automation: Authored tailored scripts for algorithmic trading and market sentiment analysis using Python (lightweight_charts), MetaTrader (MQL5), and ThinkOrSwim (thinkScript). Integrated real-time data via the Interactive Brokers (IBKR) API.

KEYSTONE ANALYTICS | Remote Consultant (Legal, Financial & Strategic Advisory) | Intermittent / Project-Based Consulted for a multinational enterprise comprising a Las Vegas parent company, a Philippine fintech arm, and associated physical service subsidiaries.

- Strategic Turnaround & Financial Recovery: Directed a critical funding strategy pivot that remedied a full year's financial loss within a 3-month period. Prevented business shutdown and drastically reduced capital burn while advising on the finalisation of core tech products.
- Venture Capital & Joint Ventures (\$2M+ Target): Acted as Lead VC Consultant for a major public-private solar farm initiative (a joint venture between a hotel magnate and the government energy provider). Directed strategic advisory for the comprehensive white paper and authored the investor pitch deck.
- Non-Dilutive Funding Strategy: Successfully navigated complex banking regulations to secure alternative funding pipelines for the solar venture, protecting the parent company from excessive equity dilution while cementing robust long-term professional partnerships.
- Fintech & Technical Advisory: Delivered comprehensive technical, legal, and financial consultation to the Philippine fintech division, guiding the development of proprietary

trading tools, application creation, agentic workflows, and integrated data scraping systems.

- **Business Establishment:** Steered the legal establishment and operational compliance regulations for new physical child enterprises, most notably a semi-private ambulance service and its accompanying SaaS dispatch application.

EDUCATION

LL.M. (Masters of Law): Legal Practice | University of Worcester (Honours) | Sep 2022 - Jun 2024

- **Specialisations:** International Law (specifically focusing on the systems surrounding international finance), the operational mechanics of legal systems, law of international organizations, treaty interpretation, administrative law, privileges and immunities, and commercial contract law.
- **Dissertation:** Economic and Cyber Warfare. Awarded full marks (100%) and a formal offer to continue research to the doctorate level.

B.A. (Hons) Politics, Philosophy and Economics (Economics Major) | Goldsmiths, University of London (Summa Cum Laude) | Sep 2016 - Jun 2020

- **Key Modules:** Macroeconomics, International Economics, Banking, Political Theory, African Conflict and Peacekeeping, and Game Theory (Decision-making under uncertainty).
- **Extracurriculars:** Proofread master's theses upon faculty request; active in Model United Nations and debate societies; contributed articles to the university newspaper.

TECHNICAL & DIGITAL PROFICIENCIES

- **Legal & GRC Tools:** Legal drafting, LexisNexis (incl. Risk Solutions), Westlaw, GDPR framework enforcement, Risk Registers, Policy architectures, DocuSign CLM, iManage/NetDocuments. Industry Platform Familiarity: Refinitiv World-Check, Chainalysis, OneTrust, TrustArc, NAVEX Global, ServiceNow GRC.
- **AI & Automation:** Agentic LLM workflows, Claude Code, structured prompting for compliance auditing, GenAI control mapping, automated drafting with human-in-the-loop guardrails.
- **Project Management & Collaboration:** Jira, Confluence, Taiga, Microsoft Office 365, Google Docs.

- Data & Productivity Software: Advanced Microsoft Excel, PowerPoint, Power BI, MS Access, Adobe Creative Suite / Adobe Photoshop.
- Programming & Scripting: Python, MQL5, thinkScript, VBA, R, Java, C#, API integration, HTML, CSS, JavaScript.
- Operating Systems & Databases: Windows, Linux, MacOS, Oracle or similar systems.
- Digital Transformation & Tech Operations: Led paper-to-Moodle digitisation and workflow automation for operational continuity and scalability. Built small Python/API tools for data retrieval and reporting automation; can validate logic/output (not a production developer). Data literate incl. basic SQL interpretation.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS & CERTIFICATIONS

- Member: Association of Certified Anti-Money Laundering Specialists (ACAMS)
- Member: International Association of Privacy Professionals (IAPP)
- Member: International Compliance Association (ICA)
- Member: International Law Association
- Candidate: SRA SQE 1 & 2 (Preparing for late-year examination to formalise admission as a Solicitor of England & Wales, supported by 5+ years of verified QWE).
- Professional Development Targets: Actively preparing to undertake industry-standard compliance certifications including CAMS (Certified Anti-Money Laundering Specialist) and CIPP/E (Certified Information Privacy Professional/Europe) to further formalise cross-border financial and data privacy expertise.

REFERENCES

- Zack Robinson | CEO, Keystone Analytics | Contact: zack@keystoneanalytics.io | +1 (814) 525-1519 | +63 969 239 4004 | Relationship: Collaborated on joint ventures and strategic partnerships between our companies over the past 4 years.
- Dr. Chris Monaghan | Head of Law and Principal Lecturer in Law, University of Worcester | Contact: c.monaghan@worc.ac.uk | Relationship: Academic advisor and mentor during postgraduate studies.
- Patricia Ann Newby, M.A. | Managing Director, Red Spark Learning C.I.C. | Contact: Tricia@mail2business.com | +33 (0) 6 76 97 13 90 | Relationship: Direct supervisor for 5 years at Red Spark Learning, overseeing project management, strategy development and general operations.